

Predicting Depression Using Questions (Screening Only)

Depression prediction using questions involves assessing mood, energy, sleep, motivation, and lifestyle patterns. This is NOT a diagnosis. These questions only help estimate emotional well-being and suggest if professional evaluation is needed.

Key Categories for Depression Screening

Category	Purpose	Example Questions
Mood & Emotion	Sadness / irritation	Do you often feel sad, empty, or hopeless?
Energy Level	Fatigue & motivation	Do you feel tired even after resting?
Sleep & Appetite	Biological patterns	Do you sleep too little or too much?
Social Interaction	Withdrawal signs	Do you avoid friends or activities you once enjoyed?
Thoughts & Focus	Cognitive health	Do you have trouble concentrating or making decisions?
Daily Functioning	Ability to carry on activities	Is it hard to complete daily tasks?
Stress & Anxiety	Related mental health factors	Do you feel anxious or overwhelmed often?

Common Warning Signs of Depression

- Persistent sadness or emotional numbness
- Loss of interest in activities
- Feeling worthless or guilty
- Excessive tiredness
- Difficulty thinking or remembering
- Changes in appetite and sleep
- Withdrawal from social life
- Frequent crying or irritation

Risk Scoring Pattern

Assign scores to responses:

- ✓ Normal mood and routine: 0
- ✓ Mild emotional difficulty: 1–2
- ✓ Ongoing sadness or difficulty functioning: 3–5

Risk Levels:

0–3 → Low risk

4–7 → Moderate risk

8+ → High risk — recommend mental health evaluation

Example extra questions:

- Have you felt like life has no purpose recently?
- Do you cry often without clear reason?
- Do you find it hard to get out of bed?

Important:

This is NOT a tool for diagnosis. It only helps identify possible signs of depression. If symptoms persist or worsen, immediate support from a mental health professional is strongly recommended. Talking to friends, family, or counselors helps. You are not alone.